

The State of the Indie Startup

A close reading of 1,000 businesses listed on TrustMRR — what they earn, where they're built, who they sell to, and how the market prices them.

Dataset frozen 30 Jul 2026 · 1,000 rows · 29 categories · 65 countries

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The Numbers at a Glance

1,000

startups analyzed in this snapshot — from pre-revenue side projects to seven-figure operators.

Combined monthly recurring revenue	\$13.47M
Combined trailing 12-month revenue	\$133.8M
Active paid subscriptions	500,597
Countries represented	65
Product categories	29
Listings currently for sale	262 (26%)

Reading this dataset: figures reflect self-reported founder data at the moment TrustMRR froze the export. Treat this as a snapshot, not a live feed.

Category Share

Where the 726 categorized startups cluster — box size is proportional to listing count.



27%

of all categorized listings are AI products — nearly 3x the #2 category, SaaS.

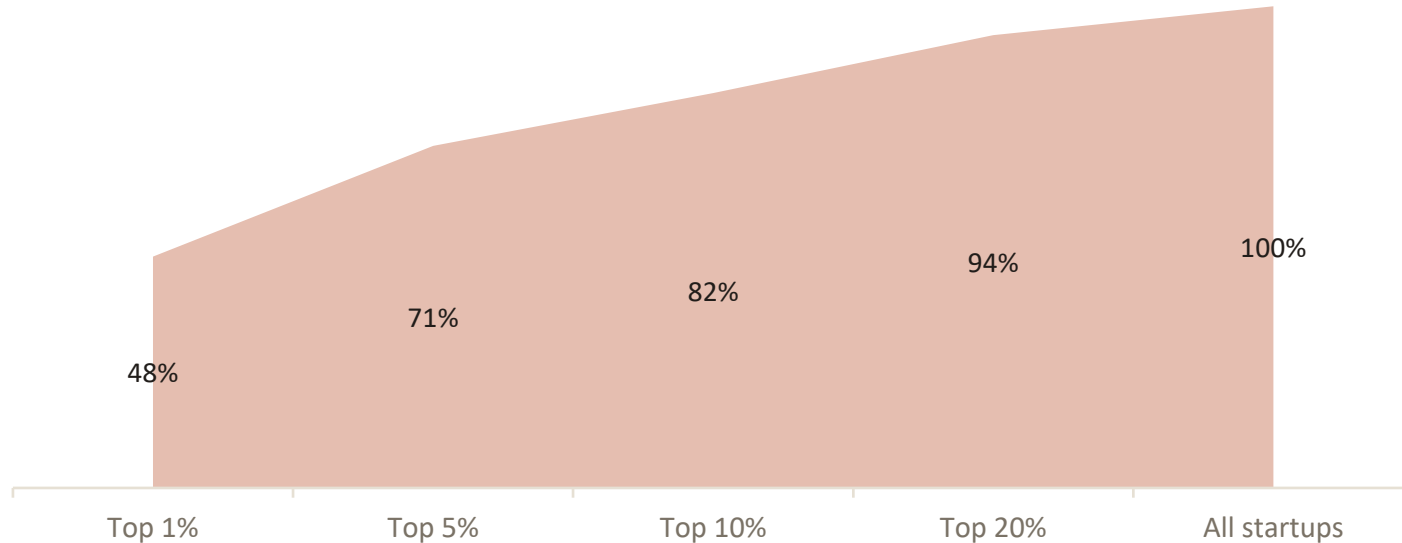
\$446

median MRR for AI startups, 58% above the dataset-wide median of \$282.

21 of 29

categories hold fewer than 20 listings — the long tail is thin and scattered.

The Long Tail



Cumulative share of total MRR captured, ranked by startup size

\$282 vs. \$13,472 — the median startup earns \$282/month; the mean is dragged 48x higher by a handful of breakout businesses.

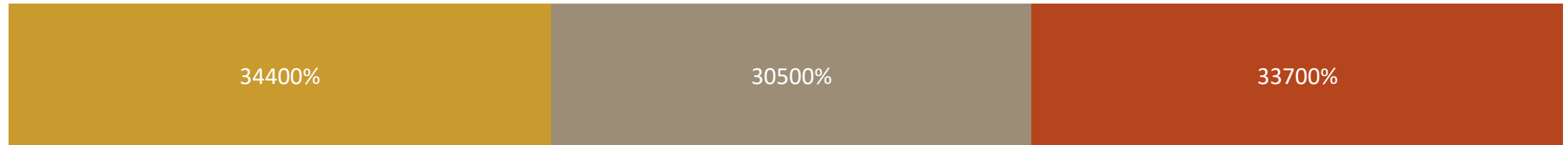
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Ten startups — one percent of the dataset — generate nearly half of all recurring revenue tracked on TrustMRR.

This is a winner-take-most market, not a level playing field.

Growth Momentum

How revenue moved for each startup over the trailing 30 days (n = 986 with growth data).



Growing 344 startups



Flat 305 startups



Declining 337 startups

Roughly a third apiece

Growth, stagnation, and decline are almost evenly split — reaching revenue doesn't mean sustaining it.

-100% to +7,900%

Growth rates are wildly volatile; a few extreme outliers pull the average (+42%) far above the 0% median.



B2B vs. B2C

Share of listings vs. share of revenue, by audience type (n = 712 with known audience).

● Share of listings ● Share of revenue

B2C

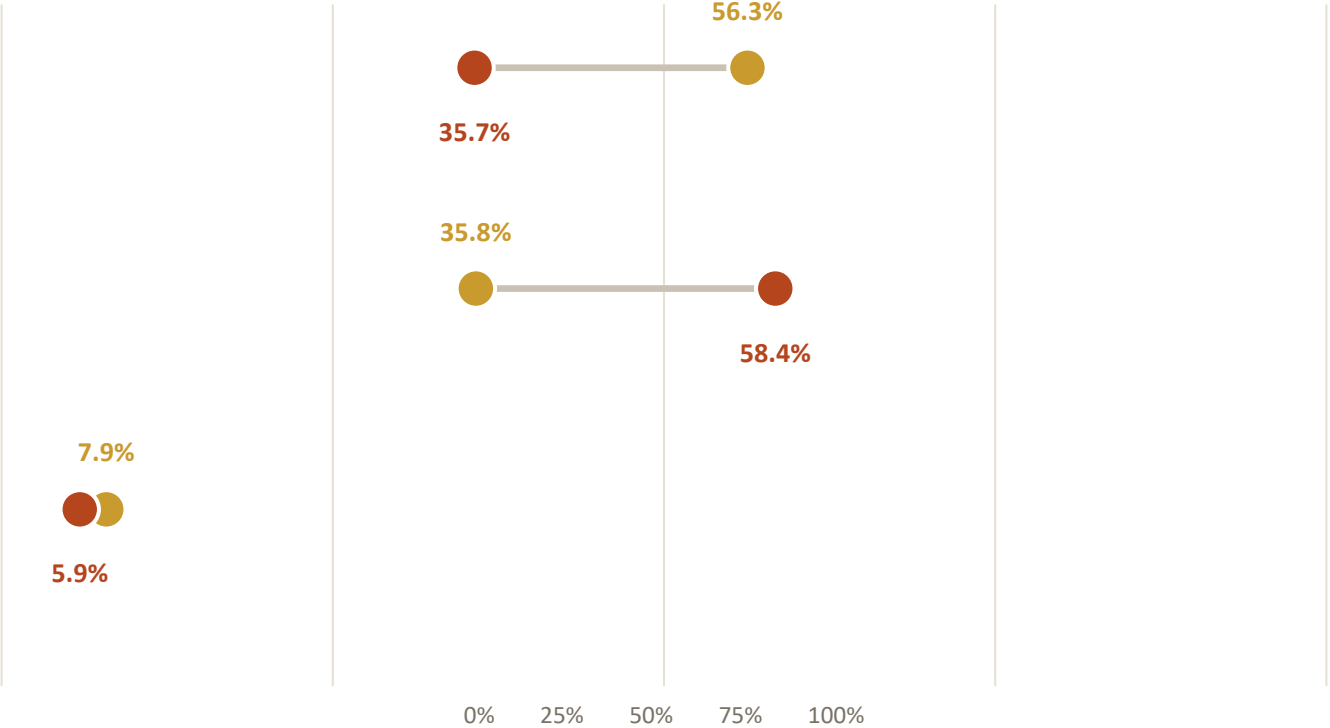
401 startups

B2B

255 startups

Both

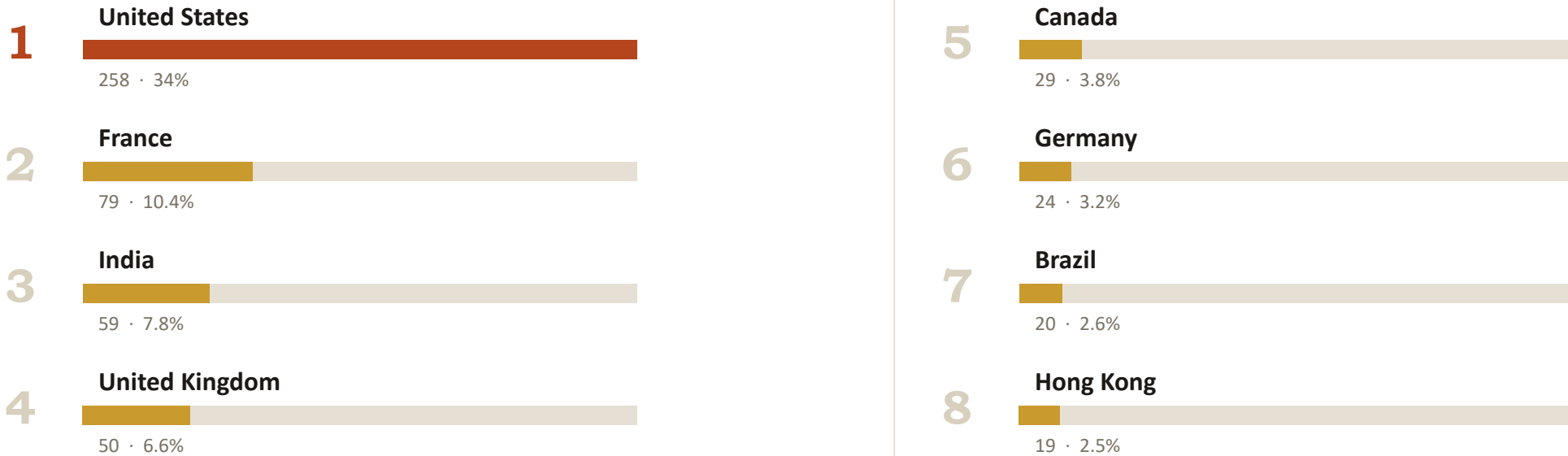
56 startups



The gap tells the story: B2B makes up just 36% of listings but 58% of revenue; B2C is the mirror image — bigger in volume, smaller in value.

Geography

Top 8 countries by number of listings (759 of 1,000 rows carry country data).



66% of every listing sits outside the US, spread across 64 other countries — France and India alone out-list Canada, Germany and Brazil combined.

Marketplace Signals

“

Sellers are listing their strongest businesses — not their failures.

Startups listed for sale earn a median of \$1,055/month, versus just \$187/month for the rest of the dataset — a 5.6x gap. It costs more to walk away from a business that's actually working, so asking prices skew toward proven, revenue-generating products.

26%

of all 1,000 startups are currently listed for sale (262 total)

\$35,000

median asking price for a startup on sale

2.3x

median asking price as a multiple of trailing revenue

5.6x

higher median MRR for on-sale vs. not-for-sale startups

Top Performers

The eight highest-earning startups in the dataset, ranked by monthly recurring revenue.

#	STARTUP	CATEGORY	COUNTRY	MRR / MO	SUBSCRIBERS
1	Stan	—	US	\$3,569,654	101,590
2	Stealth Company*	—	—	\$747,069	1,677
3	GojiberryAI	AI	US	\$494,668	4,642
4	Stealth Company*	—	—	\$364,101	2,134
5	Rezi	AI	US	\$259,701	10,749
6	Kibu	Education	US	\$234,319	375
7	Cometly	Analytics	US	\$207,616	307
8	1Lookup	SaaS	US	\$207,064	655

*"Stealth Company" listings are anonymized by TrustMRR and carry no public category or country data.

Stan alone generates 26% of the dataset's entire MRR pool — more than the bottom ~950 startups combined.

The Verdict

01**Revenue is a power law**

The top 1% of startups capture 48% of all MRR; the median business earns \$282/month.

02**AI leads, but doesn't dominate**

27% of listings are AI, out-earning the median by 58% — yet 72% of the dataset lies elsewhere.

03**Momentum isn't guaranteed**

Growth, stagnation, and decline are each running at roughly a third — revenue rarely holds steady.

04**B2B is the quieter, richer lane**

B2B is 36% of listings but 58% of revenue; B2C is the mirror image.

05**For-sale listings signal strength**

Startups on the market earn 5.6x the median MRR of those that aren't.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026. Figures reflect self-reported founder data at time of snapshot.